PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS

HEAD START

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STAFF REPORT

Date: 3/20/2025

To: PPS School Board

From: Emily Glasgow, Senior Director of PK-5 Core Academics
Dana Stiles, Principal/Director of Head Start

Subject: Head Start Action and Informational Items

BACKGROUND

A. Federal requirements call for the Governing Board of Head Starts to approve recommendations and reports for the program.

B. The Board of Directors for Portland Public Schools serves as the Governing Board for Portland Public Schools Head Start.

1. Updated PPS Head Start Policy & Procedures

1.A. Parent Policy Council – PPS Head Start has revised Parent Policy Council procedures in accordance with the Head Start Program Performance Standard §1301.3(c) , program grant requirements, and the current approved Policy Council Bylaws. PPS Head Start Parent Policy Council approved these revised procedures on December 11, 2024. Board approval of new policies/procedures is required. A Board Letter of Approval and Resolution are requested.

1.B. Community Assessment – PPS Head Start has revised the Community Assessment policy and procedure to align the Head Start Program Performance §1302.11 – Determining community strengths, needs, and resources. PPS Early Learners will conduct a comprehensive community needs assessment at least every five years. This community needs assessment will be updated annually in order to ensure appropriate design and delivery of services to meet the needs within the defined service area. PPS Head Start Parent Policy Council approved these revised procedures on December 11, 2024. Board approval of new policies/procedures is required. A Board Letter of Approval and Resolution are requested.

1.D. Active Supervision – PPS Head Start has written an Active Supervision Policy that aligns the Head Start Performance Standards §1302.90 – Personnel policies. All staff and adults in our program are responsible for actively supervising children at all times **i**n accordance with the program and district standards of conduct. PPS Head Start Parent Policy Council will review this procedures on April 9, 2024. Board approval of new

policies/procedures is required. A Board Letter of Approval and Resolution are requested.

2. 2023 – 2024 PPS Head Start Program Annual Report

The Head Start Program Performance Standards provide requirements and procedures for the Annual Report. The Annual Report includes yearlong information regarding Head Start program data. It is used as a community resource and contains information from the Program Information Report (PIR). Program budget information is also shared in the annual report. PPS Head Start Parent Policy Council reviewed the Program Annual Report on January 15, 2025. A Board Letter of Approval and Resolution are requested.

3. 2024 – 2025 PPS Head Start Program Self-Assessment Timeline

The annual Self-Assessment is a central tenet of continuous quality improvement for Head Start programs. The goal of the Self-Assessment is to meet Head Start Program Performance Standards and move toward program excellence in serving children and families. The process provides programs the means to regularly assess their own management systems and program operations in order to continually strengthen the program and the services and supports delivered to children and families. PPS Head Start Parent Policy Council approved the Self-Assessment Timeline on December 11, 2024. A Board Letter of Approval and Resolution are requested.

4. 2023 – 2024 PPS Head Start Program Information Report (PIR)

The annual Program Information Report provides comprehensive data on the services, staff, children, and families served by Head Start. All grantees are required to submit a PIR each year. The PIR is an important source of descriptive and service data for the Head Start community, their partners, Congress, and for the general public. PIR data is compiled for use at the federal, regional, state, and local levels. This report is for the Governing Body's information only. Governing Body approval is not required.

5. Eligibility, Recruitment, Selection, Enrollment, and Attendance (ERSEA) Training & Selection Criteria for SY25-26

PPS Early Learners enrolls students in Head Start according to Section 645 of the Head Start Act. Federal Poverty Guidelines are used to determine income eligibility for participation in Head Start programs. The poverty guidelines are adjusted for families of different sizes and may be used to determine financial eligibility for certain federal programs such as Head Start services. The guidelines are issued each year in the Federal Register, and as such, the program must provide an annual training to the Parent Policy Council and board on their ERSEA procedures and Enrollment Selection Criteria for the following school year. PPS Head Start Parent Policy Council received training and approved the SY25-26 Enrollment Selection Criteria on March 12, 2025. Board approval is required. A Board Letter of Approval and Resolution are requested.

6. Portland Children's Levy Mid-Year Report

PPS Head Start submitted its mid-year report as required by the Portland Children's Levy (PCL). The PCL funds four of the Head Start program's teachers and two educational assistants. The mid-year report is provided for informational awareness only. Board approval of the report is not required.

RELATED POLICIES/BEST PRACTICES

Items listed above are required to be reviewed, updated, and/or approved by the Parent Policy Council and Governing Board.

ANALYSIS OF SITUATION

All items listed above support the high quality, comprehensive wraparound services provided to the children and families attending PPS Head Start.

FISCAL IMPACT

The items included in this packet do not have any significant direct impacts on program or district funding. Some items are required as part of grant agreements (federal, state, and city) in order to maintain current funding. Policy Council fiscal documentation is linked in the meeting notes.

COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

PPS Head Start Parent Policy Council reviewed, provided input, and approved these actions/items on November 13, 2024, December 11, 2024, January 15, 2025, February 12, 2025, and March 12, 2025 as noted above and as reflected in the attached meeting minutes.

TIMELINE FOR IMPLEMENTATION / EVALUATION

The timeline for implementation will be the 2024–2025 school year.

BOARD OPTIONS WITH ANALYSIS

Board approval needed.

CONNECTION TO BOARD GOALS

The goal of PPS Head Start is to prepare the city's diverse and resilient young children for successful transitions to kindergarten and beyond by leveraging each child's strengths, building their social competence, and developing school readiness skills.

In June 2022, the PPS School Board established a new set of goals. "It remains the core mission and responsibility of our school system to ensure that every student has opportunities to thrive and experience success. Unfortunately, too many students have been historically underserved, and there has not been evidence of racial equity in PPS as revealed by persistent gaps in student outcomes along the lines of race. We are dedicated to the continuous improvements necessary to drive the system shifts that will better support our students, educators, and leaders and result in improved student performance." The Board adopted the following four priorities for the 2022-2027 time period to move the school district toward the above aspirations:

- *Improve Third Grade Reading achievement*
- *Improve Fifth Grade Mathematics achievement*
- *Improve Eighth Grade Readiness*
- *Improve High School Graduation rates*

The above items support the district's and School Board's vision and priorities.

STAFF RECOMMENDATION

Develop Board resolutions and obtain signatures of approval of the Board Chair of the attached documents.

As a member of the PPS Executive Leadership Team, I have reviewed this staff report.
__KH_____ (Initials) – Kristina Howard

ATTACHMENTS

A. Policy and Procedures
    a. Parent Policy Council
    b. Community Assessment
    c. Active Supervision
B. Policy and Procedures Board Approval Letter
    a. Parent Policy Council
    b. Community Assessment
    c. Active Supervision
C. Policy and Procedures Board Resolution
    a. Parent Policy Council
    b. Community Assessment
    c. Active Supervision
D. 2023-2024 Program Annual Report
E. 2023-2024 Program Annual Report Board Approval Letter
F. 2023-2024 Program Annual Report Board Resolution
G. 2024-2025 Self-Assessment Timeline
H. 2024-2025 Self-Assessment Timeline Board Approval Letter
I. 2024-2025 Self-Assessment Timeline Board Resolution
J. 2023-2024 Program Information Report (PIR)
K. 2025-26 ERSEA Training & Selection Criteria
L. 2025-26 ERSEA Training & Selection Criteria Board Approval Letter
M. 2025-26 ERSEA Training & Selection Criteria Board Resolution
N. Portland Children's Levy Mid-Year Report
O. 11.13.24 PPS Head Start Parent Policy Council Meeting Minutes and Financial Report
P. 12.11.24 PPS Head Start Parent Policy Council Meeting Minutes and Financial Report
Q. 1.15.25 PPS Head Start Parent Policy Council Meeting Minutes and Financial Report
R. 2.12.25 PPS Head Start Parent Policy Council Meeting Minutes and Financial Report
S. 3.12.25 PPS Head Start Parent Policy Council Meeting Minutes and Financial Report